Group policies

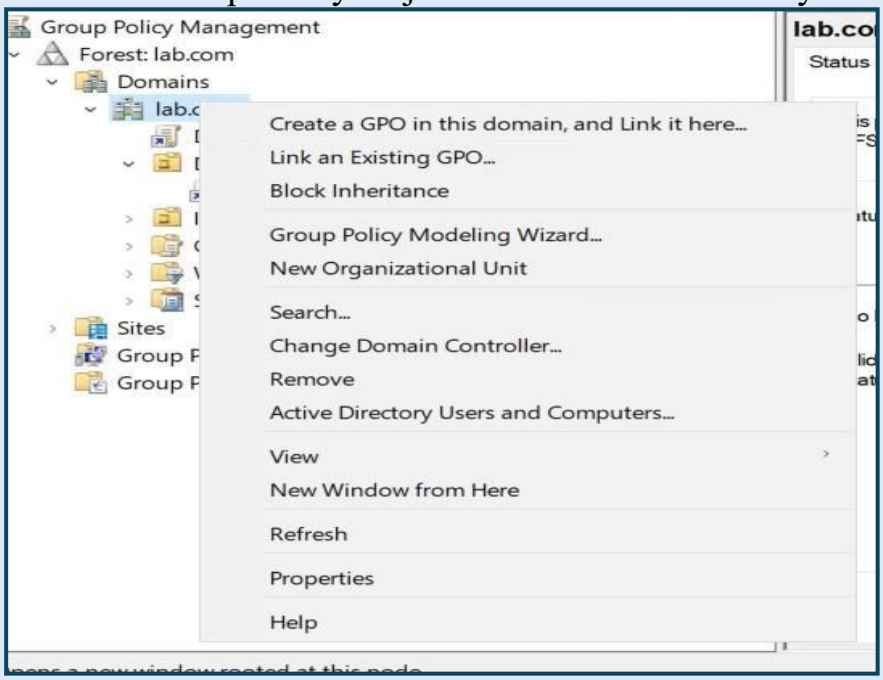
1. **Open Group Policy Management Console (GPMC) on your Windows Server and create a new GPO named 'PasswordPolicyDemo' that enforces a minimum password length of 8 characters. Link it to your test OU and verify the setting is applied using gpresult. O**

Step 1: Open Group Policy Management Console (GPMC)

Opened Group Policy Management Console on Windows Server and accessed the lab.com domain.

Step 2: Create the GPO

Created a Group Policy Object named PasswordPolicy under Group Policy Objects.

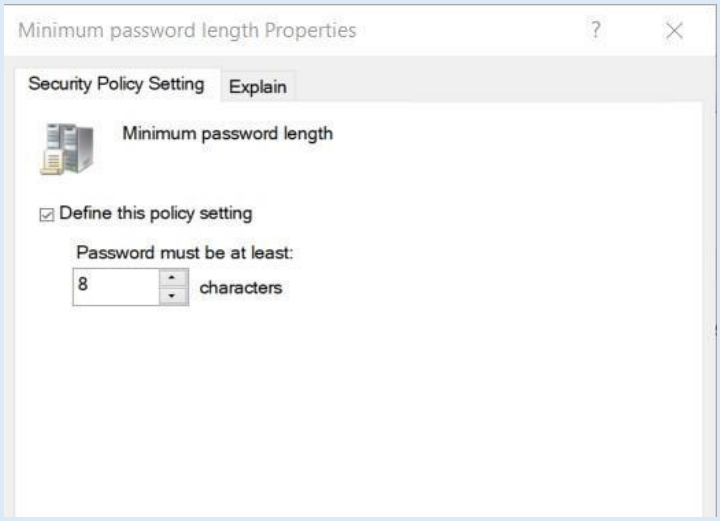


Step 3: Configure Password Policy

Navigated to:

Computer Configuration → Policies → Windows Settings → Security Settings → Account Policies → Password Policy

Configured the Minimum password length setting to 8 characters.



Step 4: Link the GPO

Linked the GPO to the test Organizational Unit (IT OU).

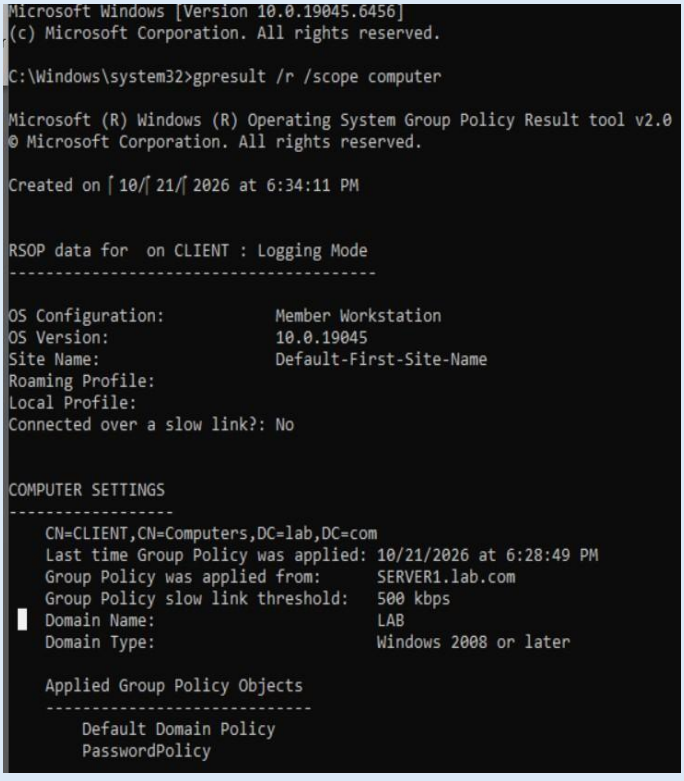
Step 5: Update Group Policy On the

Windows 10 client, executed:

```
gpupdate /force
```

Step 6: Verify the Applied GPO

Generated the Group Policy results report and checked the Applied GPOs section. The report showed Default Domain Policy and PasswordPolicy.



2. **Configure a GPO to restrict access to the Control Panel for all users in a specific OU, similar to how public computers in a cybercafe or college lab prevent users from changing system settings.

Hint: In the GPO, navigate to User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Control Panel and set 'Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings' to Enabled.**
    -

Step 1: Open Group Policy Management Console

Opened Group Policy Management Console (GPMC) on Windows Server using the gpmc.msc command.

Step 2: Create a New GPO

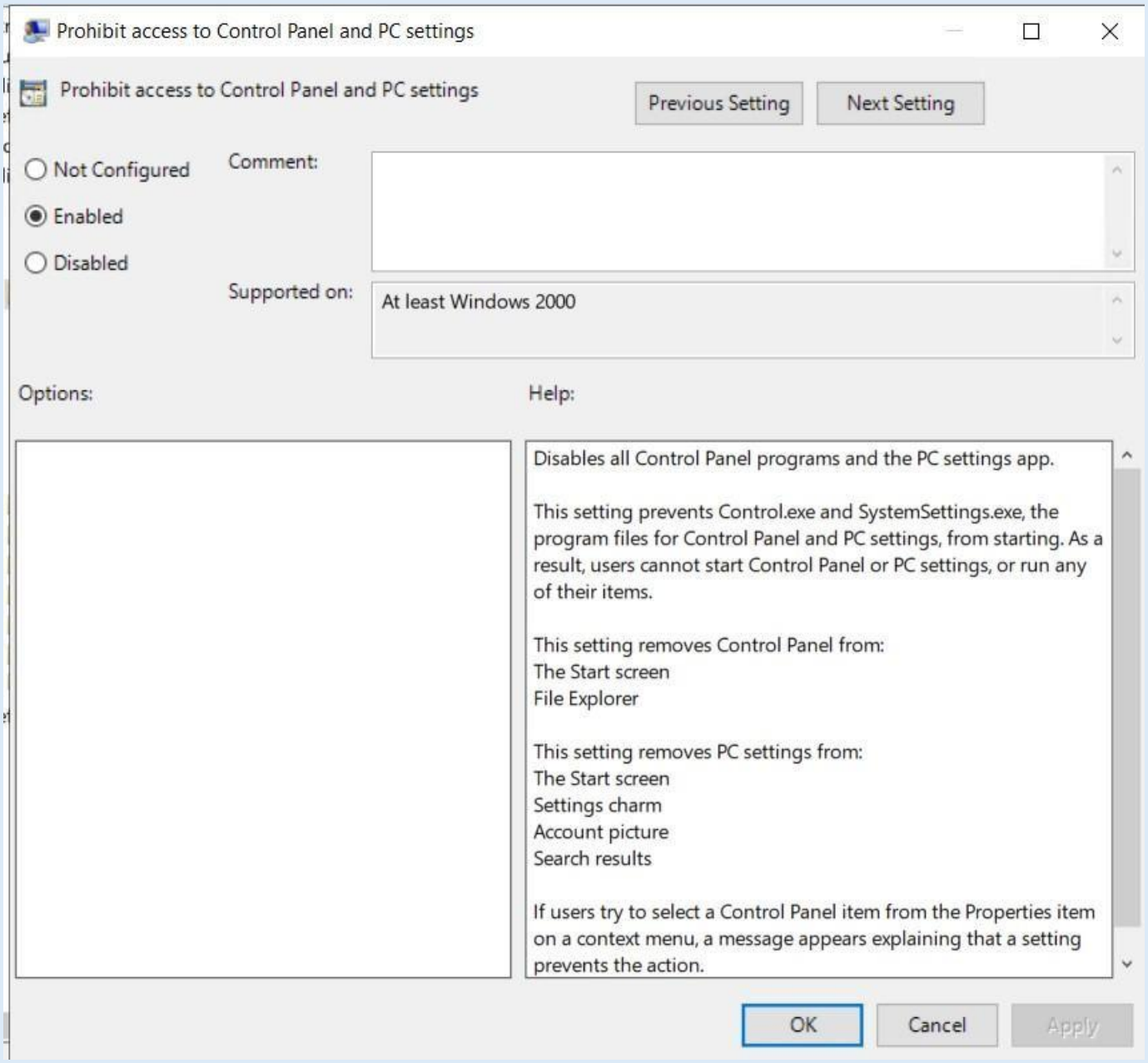
Created a new Group Policy Object named BlockControlPanel under the Group Policy Objects container.

Step 3: Configure the Policy

Edited the GPO and navigated to:

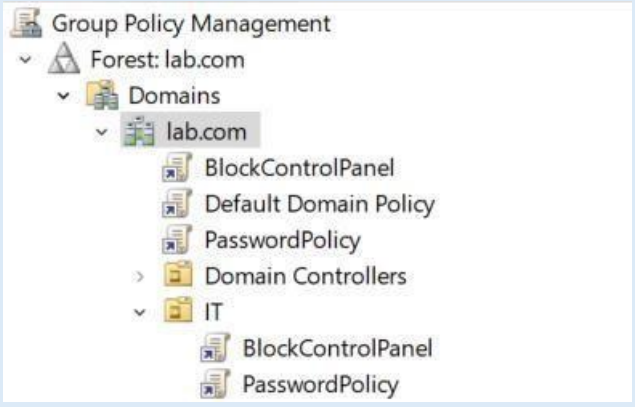
User Configuration → Policies → Administrative Templates → Control Panel

Opened the setting **Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings**, selected **Enabled**, and clicked Apply and OK.



Step 4: Link the GPO to the IT OU

Linked BlockControlPanel to the IT Organizational Unit under the lab.com domain using **Link an Existing GPO**.

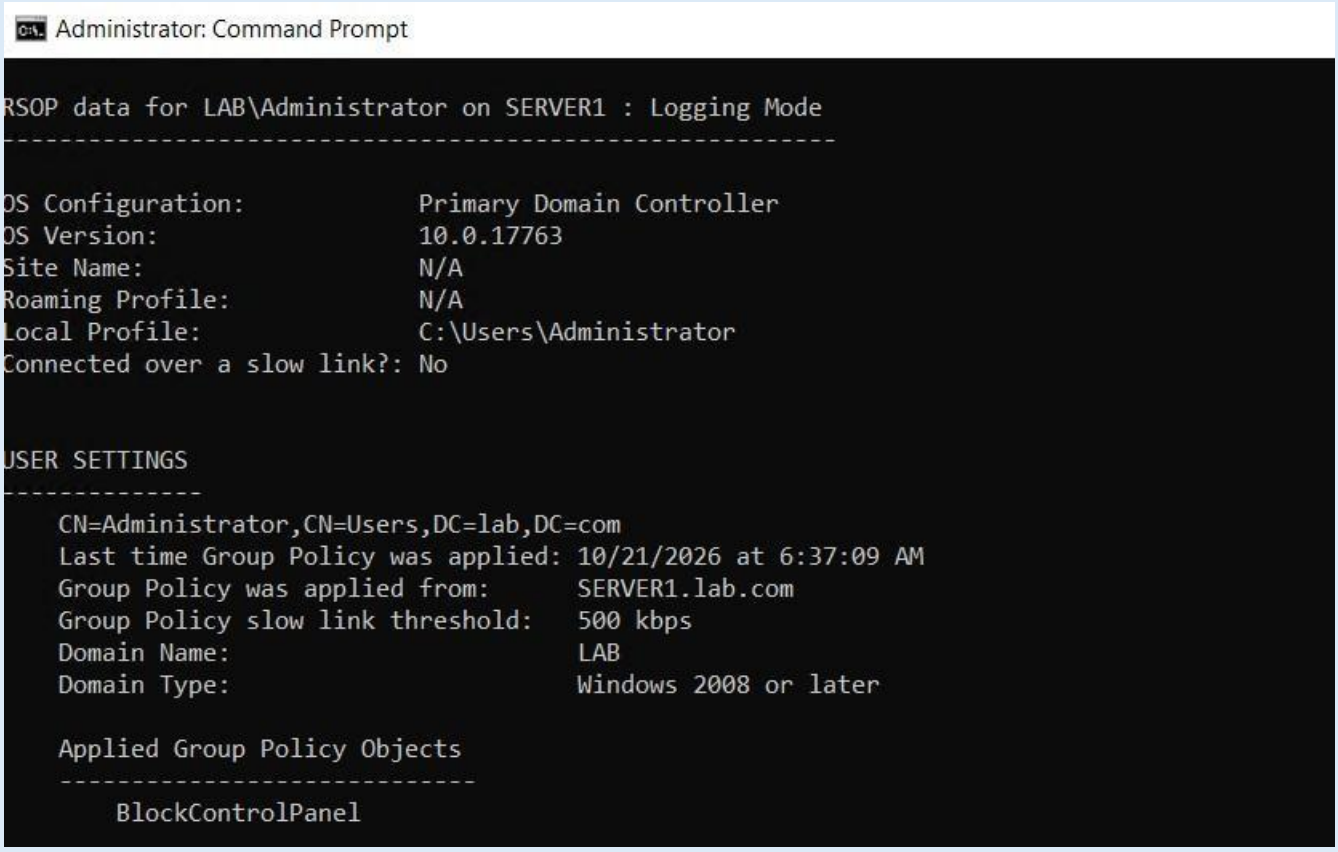


Step 5: Update Group Policy on the Client

Logged in to the Windows 10 client using a domain user account located in the IT OU and executed:

gpupdate /force

Step 6: Verify the Applied Policy



Control Panel Block



3. **Edit your 'PasswordPolicy' GPO to enable account lockout after 3 invalid login attempts and set the lockout duration to 10 minutes. Run gpupdate /force on a client PC and test the lockout by entering the wrong password.**

Step 1: Open Group Policy Management Console

Opened Group Policy Management Console (GPMC) on Windows Server using the gpmc.msc command.

Navigated to Forest: lab.com → Domains → lab.com → Group Policy Objects.

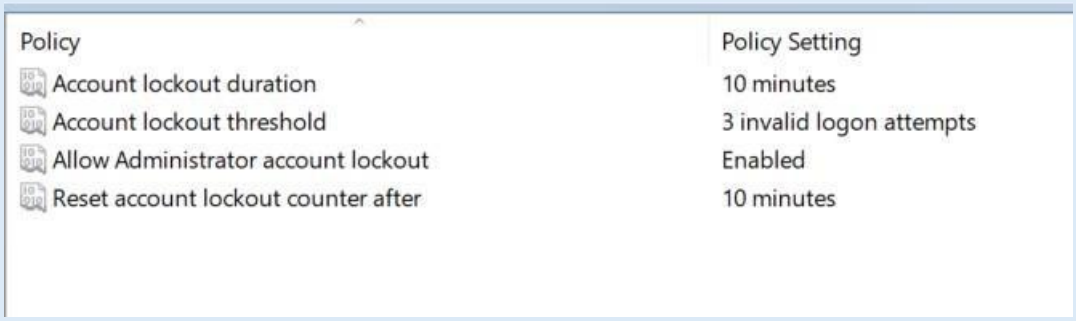
Step 2: Edit the PasswordPolicy GPO

Right-clicked the existing PasswordPolicy GPO and selected **Edit**.

Navigated to:

Computer Configuration → Policies → Windows Settings → Security Settings → Account Policies → Account Lockout Policy

Step 3: Configure Account Lockout Settings



Step 4: Update Group Policy on the Client

On the Windows 10 domain-joined client, opened Command Prompt as Administrator and executed:

gpupdate /force

Step 5: Verify the Applied Policy

```
C:\Users\Administrator>net accounts /domain
Force user logoff how long after time expires?:       Never
Minimum password age (days):                          1
Maximum password age (days):                          42
Minimum password length:                              7
Length of password history maintained:                24
Lockout threshold:                                    3
Lockout duration (minutes):                           10
Lockout observation window (minutes):                 10
Computer role:                                        PRIMARY
The command completed successfully.


C:\Users\Administrator>
```

The PasswordPolicy GPO was configured with an account lockout threshold of 3 invalid login attempts and an account lockout duration of 10 minutes. The effective settings and client-side lockout behavior were checked.

4. Document all GPO settings you applied in this session (password policy, desktop restriction, lockout policy) in a table format, and for each setting, describe its expected impact on users in 1-2 sentences.

No.	GPO / Policy	Setting	Configured value	Expected impact on users
1	PasswordPolicy	Minimum password length	Intended: 8 characters; observed effective value: 7	Users would need to create passwords meeting the effective minimum length. The latest net accounts /domain output showed 7, so the intended 8-character setting still needs verification.
2	BlockControlPanel	Prohibit access to Control Panel and PC settings	Enabled	Users whose accounts are in the targeted IT OU should be prevented from opening Control Panel and Windows Settings. This helps stop users from changing system configurations on shared computers.
3	PasswordPolicy	Account lockout threshold	3 invalid attempts	A domain account should become locked after three unsuccessful sign-in attempts, helping protect against repeated password guessing.
4	PasswordPolicy	Account lockout duration	10 minutes	A locked account should automatically become available after 10 minutes, provided the effective domain policy specifies this duration.
5	PasswordPolicy	Reset account lockout counter after	10 minutes	If no further failed sign-in attempts occur during the observation period, the failedattempt counter resets. This reduces the chance of occasional mistakes accumulating indefinitely.